COURSE CODE: CSE0001

PROJECT REPORT

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

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CONTENTS:

1. INTRODUCTION

2. TASK 1: DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

3. TASK 2: STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

4. TASK 3: CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

5. TASK 4: PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQUETTE

6. TASK 5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS & PREVENTION

7. CONCLUSION

8. REFERENCES

01

INTRODUCTION

In this project, I have taken on the professional role of a Student Digital Ambassador at my college. My primary responsibility in this position is to assist my peers in navigating the complexities of the modern digital world, ensuring they can communicate safely, responsibly, and professionally. This Digital Literacy Portfolio serves as my first major assignment, designed to be presented to the faculty committee and shared with my entire batch.

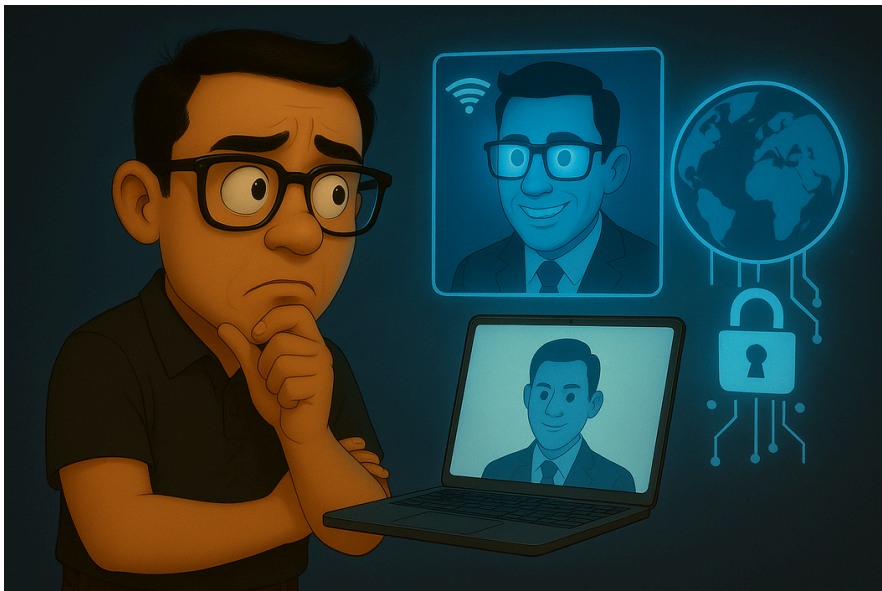
To build this portfolio, I completed five distinct tasks that map directly to the five modules of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course. These tasks include creating visual awareness resources, setting up a professional online presence, exploring coding collaboration tools, mastering email etiquette, and researching cybercrime prevention. Through these activities, I aim to demonstrate my ability to lead by example in the digital space.

02

TASK 1: DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

FOR THIS TASK, I USED CANVA TO DESIGN A ONE-PAGE DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC. MY DESIGN IS STRUCTURED INTO THREE CLEAR SECTIONS TO HELP MY PEERS NAVIGATE THE DIGITAL LANDSCAPE EFFECTIVELY. FIRST, I DEFINED DIGITAL LITERACY TO ESTABLISH A FOUNDATIONAL UNDERSTANDING. SECOND, I HIGHLIGHTED ESSENTIAL SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES, SUCH AS USING 2FA AND RECOGNIZING PHISHING ATTEMPTS, WHICH ARE CRITICAL FOR PROTECTING PERSONAL DATA. FINALLY, I INCLUDED A SECTION ON MAINTAINING A PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE, EMPHASIZING THE IMPORTANCE OF PLATFORMS LIKE LINKEDIN FOR CAREER GROWTH.

ONE THING I FOUND PARTICULARLY INTERESTING WHILE MAKING THIS INFOGRAPHIC WAS THE CHALLENGE OF "VISUAL HIERARCHY." I HAD TO LEARN HOW TO USE DIFFERENT FONT SIZES AND COLOR CONTRASTS TO ENSURE THE MOST IMPORTANT SAFETY TIPS CAUGHT THE READER'S EYE FIRST. IT WAS FASCINATING TO SEE HOW A COMPLEX TOPIC LIKE DIGITAL SAFETY COULD BE CONDENSED INTO SIMPLE, ACTIONABLE VISUAL CUES. THIS PROCESS HELPED ME REALIZE THAT BEING A DIGITAL AMBASSADOR ISN'T JUST ABOUT KNOWING THE FACTS, BUT ALSO ABOUT COMMUNICATING THEM IN A WAY THAT IS ACCESSIBLE AND ENGAGING FOR EVERYONE.



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TASK 2: STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

For this task, I established my professional digital presence by setting up accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose GitHub to showcase my coding projects and collaboration skills, specifically creating a profile README to introduce myself to the developer community. I utilized LinkedIn to build a professional network, ensuring my education section accurately reflects my current degree and institution at VIT Bhopal. Finally, I selected Kaggle as a platform to explore data science competitions and build a portfolio of analytical work. Together, these platforms form the foundation of my professional identity and allow me to engage with both the academic and tech industries.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as dynamic records of my growth as an engineer. I will use GitHub to host my academic assignments and personal side projects, demonstrating my technical evolution to potential internship coordinators. On LinkedIn, I intend to document my certifications, participate in industry discussions, and connect with alumni to find mentorship opportunities. Kaggle will serve as my primary space for practicing real-world problem-solving and staying updated on AI trends. By consistently updating these profiles, I aim to graduate with a robust digital portfolio that makes me highly competitive in the global job market.

04

TASK 3: CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

For the third module of this project, I focused on building technical and collaborative skills by using HackerRank and Google Workspace. On HackerRank, I successfully completed the "Solve Me First" challenge, which allowed me to practice basic Python syntax and understand the logic of automated code evaluation. Additionally, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This tool included exactly five questions designed to test my peers' knowledge of online safety and professional digital behavior, featuring both multiple-choice and short-answer formats. I also linked this form to a Google Sheet to manage and analyze incoming responses efficiently.

Academically, these tools will be indispensable throughout my B.Tech journey. Platforms like HackerRank provide a structured environment to improve my problem-solving speed and prepare for technical interviews. Meanwhile, mastering Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets will enhance my ability to collaborate on group research projects and organize data for lab reports. By integrating these platforms into my daily study routine, I can ensure that I remain both technically proficient and highly organized in a collaborative academic setting.

05 TASK 4: PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQUETTE

A significant real-world problem caused by poor digital communication often occurs during the internship hiring process. I recently read a scenario where a qualified candidate lost a job offer because they used an unprofessional "text-speak" tone and lacked a clear subject line in their email correspondence with a recruiter. This led the recruiter to believe the candidate lacked the necessary professional maturity for the corporate environment.

To prevent this, the student should have followed a standard email structure, including a clear subject line and a formal greeting. Using professional language instead of slang and proofreading for grammatical errors would have demonstrated respect for the recruiter's time and the company's culture. This situation highlights that in the digital world, your writing style is often the first impression you make, and maintaining high etiquette standards is crucial for academic and career success.

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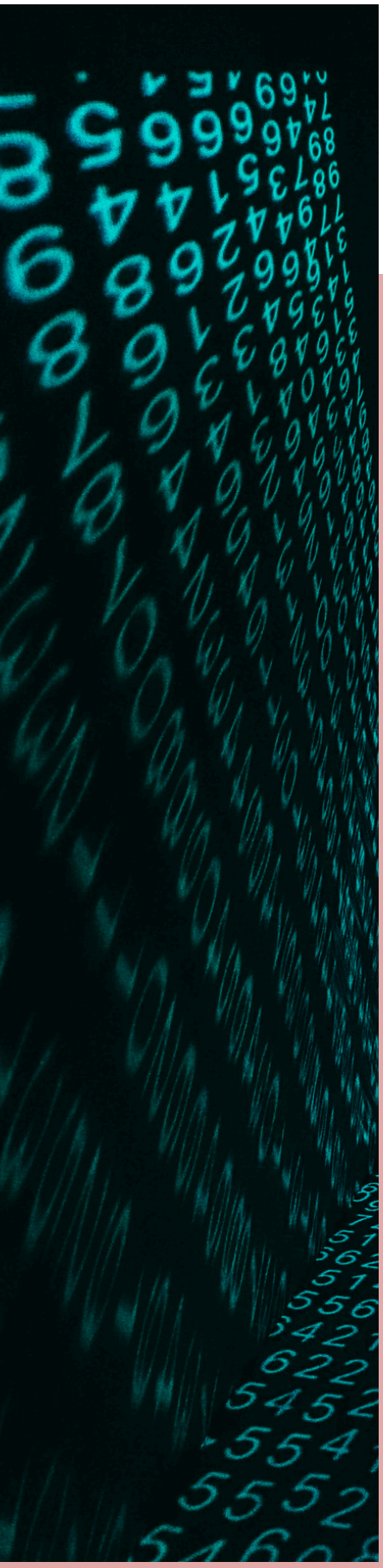

TASK 5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS & PREVENTION

While researching UPI and online payment fraud for this task, I was most surprised by how sophisticated "social engineering" has become. I learned that many scammers do not use complex hacking tools but instead rely on psychological manipulation, such as creating a false sense of urgency or fear, to trick students into sharing OTPs or scanning "collection" QR codes. It was eye-opening to see how easily a moment of distraction can lead to significant financial loss.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to public Wi-Fi and app permissions. I have decided to stop performing any financial transactions or accessing sensitive accounts while connected to unsecured campus or cafe networks. Additionally, I will now perform a monthly audit of my app permissions to ensure that no third-party applications have unnecessary access to my contacts or messages, significantly reducing my digital footprint and risk of identity theft.

07

CONCLUSION

Completing this Digital Literacy project has been a transformative experience that deepened my understanding of the responsibilities associated with being a Student Digital Ambassador. By moving through all five modules, I have not only enhanced my technical skills in Python and data management but also mastered the art of professional communication and cyber safety. This portfolio now serves as a permanent record of my digital growth and readiness for the professional world. I feel better equipped to guide my peers toward safe and effective digital practices while maintaining my own professional identity online.

08

REFERENCES

- Canva: https://www.canva.com Used for Task 1 Infographic)
- GitHub: https://github.com (Used for Portfolio and Project Hosting)
- LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com (Used for Professional Profile)
- HackerRank: https://www.hackerrank.com (Used for Coding Practice)
- Google Forms: https://forms.google.com (Used for Collaboration Task)
- National Cyber Crime Portal: [suspicious link removed] (Research Source for Task 5)